Incident report: slow report exports in merchant portal

Document: INC-203

Date: 2026-02-24

Services: merchant-portal

Summary

On 2026-02-24, merchants using the merchant-portal experienced timeouts when exporting CSV reports containing more than 100,000 rows. The issue was classified as SEV3. Exports failed because the report generation logic ran synchronously within web request handlers, which were subject to a 30-second request timeout. Merchants could work around the issue by exporting data using smaller date ranges. See STS-203 for status updates during the incident.

Impact

Merchants attempting to export large payment reports received timeout errors instead of CSV files. This prevented access to comprehensive historical payment data through the portal's export feature. The impact was limited to users exporting reports with more than 100,000 rows; smaller exports completed successfully.

Timeline

- 09:15 UTC: Merchants report export failures in support channels

- 09:45 UTC: Merchant Experience team confirms timeouts on large report exports

- 10:30 UTC: Root cause identified as synchronous processing within request handler

- 11:00 UTC: Workaround documented and communicated to affected merchants

Root cause

Report exports were implemented as synchronous operations executed within the merchant-portal web request handler. When merchants requested exports of more than 100,000 rows, the processing time exceeded the 30-second request timeout, causing the request to fail before the CSV could be generated and returned.

Resolution

CHG-1025 was implemented to refactor report exports as background jobs, removing the dependency on the request timeout and allowing exports of any size to complete successfully.

Follow-up actions

- Monitor export completion times after CHG-1025 deployment

- Review other long-running operations in merchant-portal for similar timeout issues

- Update export documentation with expected processing times for large datasets